

AstraZeneca

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Approvals		
Approval Reason Owner Approval	Approver Chavoshi, Soheil	Date 2018/04/13 19:05:51

ASTRAZENECA PUBLICATIONS SIGN-OFF (PSO) PROCEDURE

WHY IT MATTERS

We conduct innovative research that we commit to publish in accordance with Good Publication Practice. The Publications Sign-Off (PSO) procedure ensures that any intellectual property (IP) issues are addressed before material is shared externally for presentation or publication, that the content is scientifically accurate, and that publications have been prepared in line with the AstraZeneca Global Publications Standard.

HOW WE DO IT

We complete the PSO procedure before any proposed medical or scientific publication is disclosed to an external audience. This procedure serves as the final endorsement of a publication and ensures that all publications undergo an appropriate review before they are considered submission or presentation ready. Some publications require re-PSO after significant changes or addition of further information after initial PSO review.

Scope of the PSO Procedure

- We define “publications” covered in the PSO procedure as manuscripts (primary, secondary, reviews, brief reports, etc); abstracts; slide presentations; posters; journal supplements; AstraZeneca-sponsored supplemental materials and digital content accompanying a journal publication; letters to the editor; books and book chapters; and student theses and oral presentations based on AstraZeneca research. Also included in this definition are product-related publications in non–peer-reviewed, trade journals; newspaper and magazine articles; and commentaries, whether in paper, audio, digital, or electronic media formats, and containing medical or other scientific (hereafter referred to as “scientific”) content. This definition further includes presentations and publications for external disclosure that have an AstraZeneca employee as a presenter or author.
- We submit scientific presentations and publications covering products, projects, processes, and know-how (defined as “knowledge, skill, or expertise with respect to a process or a practical or technical matter or issue”) through the PSO process from all areas of our business, including external collaborations with academic research organizations, partners, collaborators, and alliances.
- Non-scientific publications—defined as those not related to science and not including information on company products, projects, processes, or know-how, and that do not require IP review—may also undergo the PSO process, but this is decided by the functional area (all MedImmune nonscientific publications must follow the PSO process). Otherwise, approval of these publications is covered by the AstraZeneca Communications Policy.
- Publications from externally sponsored research (ESR) studies (either investigator-initiated sponsored research [IISR] or externally sponsored collaborative research [ESCR]) undergo review for medical accuracy, disclosure, and IP, using the PSO procedure. Although IISR publications only require PSO review, any ESCR publication that includes company employees as authors or contributors must receive PSO sign-off.

PSO Review Requirements

- The PSO requirements for review are specific to the presentation or publication content and the originating functional area.
- We submit all publications through the mandatory PSO steps to check for compliance with the AstraZeneca Global Publications Standard as well as any special requirements of the relevant science unit, function, global product team, or marketing company (AZ affiliates).
- All publications related to investigational products, development projects, clinical studies, research processes, manufacturing processes, and technology and know-how, or new indications for marketed products require medical or scientific accuracy and IP review. This includes all external presentations and publications on active or terminated products, even if the products are anonymised in the presentation or publication.
- When appropriate, IP review can be delegated by a patent attorney to another designated expert upon agreement by both parties. An IP attorney also may, on a product-by-product basis, exempt certain categories of publication from IP review if the risk to IP is deemed to be low (eg, review articles or health economics and outcomes research studies for mature products).
- Categories of publications that do not require legal IP review but are still tracked and documented include:
 - Nonscientific publications that do not contain information on AstraZeneca /MedImmune products, processes, or technology and know-how. These publications originating from MedImmune must follow the PSO process for functional review, as indicated in the PSO reviewer assignment guide below.
 - Previously signed-off publications that have only been restyled or reformatted or had content removed to comply with formatting or word-count limitations for submission to a different journal.
 - Congress encores (ie, previously signed-off and submitted/presented abstracts, posters, and presentations) for submission or presentation to a new congress and that have had only format or style changes or content removed
- Previously signed-off publications containing content revisions that include new or revised text or data (eg, response to journal reviewers' comments, different venue) require IP and other functional PSO sign-off.
- Datavision and Clear are the enterprise-wide e-tools for submitting & conducting PSO reviews.

Submission of Publication Proposals

- Marketing companies (AZ affiliates) are highly encouraged to submit proposals for new publications for approval before starting work on the publication. Marketing companies can use Clear (or Datavision, if available) to submit their proposals.

PSO reviewer guidance tables

- The summary tables below provide guidance on the minimum sign-off requirements for different business units and functions using the PSO process.
- Where a publication comes from a part of the organisation not included in the reviewer guidance table, the most appropriate sign-off should be selected based on the content of the publication and the reporting line of the author/submitter.
- Where the PSO submitting author's functional head is also an author on the publication, the review will be conducted a level above, ie, by the functional head's manager, unless:

- The functional head reports directly to a Senior Executive Team (SET) member --- functional heads who are in a SET-1 role have sufficient seniority and accountability to responsibly sign off on publications that they co-author.
- The functional head's manager is in a Commercial role --- in such cases, an equivalent-level Medical, Clinical or scientific signatory will be identified to perform PSO.

Table 1A. IMED PSO Reviewer Assignment Guide		
Publication Type	Reviewer	Additional Information
Nonscientific	1. IMED Leadership Team: 1 (within reporting line of author)	Nonscientific publications may follow the PSO process, but this is decided by the function. Otherwise, approval of these publications is covered by the AstraZeneca Global Communications Policy.
Discovery Non-Product Specific	1. IMED Leadership Team: 1 (within reporting line of author) 2. Legal IP	Depending on the Function/TA, Legal IP review might be delegated to IMED LT or members of the Innovation Network team
Discovery Product Specific	1. IMED Leadership Team: 1 (within reporting line of author) 2. IMED Leadership Team: 0 (within reporting line of Project Lead) 3. Project Lead 4. Legal IP	Include GPVP/PDTL in sign-off, if GPT or PDT in place. PL/GPL copied on review to ensure that publication is in the tactical plan.
Product Specific with Clinical Data	1. IMED Leadership Team: 1 (within reporting line of author) 2. IMED Leadership Team: 0 (within reporting line of Project Lead) 3. Project Lead 4. Early Clinical Development Physician 5. GML or GPVP (if GPT in place), GCL, or Early Clinical Development Physician or Head (if no GPT) 6. Legal IP	PL/GPL copied on review to ensure that publication is in the tactical plan
If the publication contains MedImmune author(s), the PSO review must include the corresponding MedImmune reviewers as per Table 1B.		

Table 1B. MedImmune (including any acquisitions) PSO Reviewer Assignment Guide		
Publication Type	Reviewer *	Additional Information
R&D		
Nonscientific	1. Department/Function Head within reporting line of author	Pre-PSO Review: 1. Functional Lead (Sr Dir/Dir reporting to Functional/Department Head)
Scientific**	1. R&D Department/Function Head (SVP/VP). If clinical data in publication, also corresponding Clinical TA Head. 2. Legal IP 3. iMED Leader (cc)	Pre-PSO Review: 1. Functional Lead (Sr Dir/Dir reporting to Functional/Department Head) 2. PDTL/GPVP, if applicable 3. Partner via Biologics Project Manager, if applicable
Clinical Biologics		
Nonscientific	1. Clinical TA Head (SVP/VP)	Pre-PSO Review: 1. Functional Lead (Sr Dir/Dir reporting to Functional/Department Head)
Scientific**	1. Clinical TA Head (SVP/VP). If translational data in publication, also Translational Sciences Function Head 2. Legal IP 3. iMED Leader (cc)	Pre-PSO Review: 1. Functional Lead (Sr Dir /Dir reporting to Functional/Department Head) 2. PDTL/GPVP 3. Partner via Biologics Project Manager, if applicable
Enabling Functions		
Nonscientific	1. Department/Function Head within reporting line of author	Pre-PSO Review: 1. Functional Lead (Sr Dir/Dir reporting to Functional/Department Head)
Scientific**	1. Department/Function Head within reporting line of author 2. Legal IP	Pre-PSO Review: 1. Functional Lead (Sr Dir/Dir reporting to Functional/Department Head) 2. PDTL/GPVP, if applicable 3. Partner via Biologics Project Manager, if applicable
*If the publication contains MedImmune data that have been anonymised, PDTL and/or Partner (if applicable) pre-PSO approval is not required; approval from the Functional Lead is still required. Include the related MEDI number in the PSO form and a note in the Comments section that identifies how the MedImmune data are anonymized in the publication. **If the publication contains AstraZeneca author(s), the PSO review must include the corresponding AstraZeneca reviewers as per Table(s) 1A and/or 1C/1D.		

Table 1C. Global Medicines Development PSO Reviewer Assignment Guide		
Publication Type	Reviewer	Additional Information
Non-scientific	1. Functional head of author	Nonscientific publications may follow the PSO process, but this is decided by the function. Otherwise, approval of these publications is covered by the AstraZeneca Communications Policy.
Therapy Area Specific	1. Global Publications Lead 2. Functional head of author 3. GML(s) or GPVP(s) and PDTL(s) of products within TA 4. Legal IP	Legal IP may exempt some publications from the IP review requirement
Product Specific	1. Global Publications Lead 2. Functional head of author 3. Medical Science Director or equivalent physician 4. GML, Global Product Director/VP Development Products 5. Legal IP	
If the publication contains MedImmune author(s), the PSO review must include the corresponding MedImmune reviewers as per Table 1B.		

Table 1D. Global Medical Affairs & Oncology Business Unit PSO Reviewer Assignment Guide		
Publication Type	Reviewer	Additional Information
Nonscientific	1. Functional Head of Author	Nonscientific publications may follow the PSO process, but this is decided by the function. Otherwise, approval of these publications is covered by the AstraZeneca Communications Policy.
Therapy Area Specific	1. Global Publications Lead 2. Functional head of author 3. GML(s) or GPVP(s) and PDTL(s) of products within TA 4. Legal IP	Legal IP may exempt some publications from the IP review requirement.
Product Specific (Preclinical)	1. Global Publications Lead 2. Project lead within relevant iMed 3. GML, Global Product Director/VP Development Products 4. Legal IP	
Product Specific (Clinical)	1. Global Publications Lead 2. Medical Science Director or equivalent physician 3. GML, Global Product Director/VP Development Products 4. Legal IP	Includes any publication containing clinical data that supports the product/brand. Legal IP may exempt some publications from the IP review requirement.
Medical Evidence and Outcomes Research Group		
Nonscientific	1. Functional Head of author	Nonscientific publications may follow the PSO process, but this is decided by the function. Otherwise, approval of these publications is covered by the AstraZeneca Communications Policy.
Therapy Area Specific	1. Global Publications Lead 2. Functional Head of author 3. GMLs, GPVP(s), and PDTL(s) of products within TA 4. Legal IP	Legal IP may exempt some publications from the IP review requirement
Product Specific	1. Global Publications Lead 2. Functional Head of author 3. GML, PDTL, or GP Director/VP 4. Legal IP	Legal IP may exempt some publications from the IP review requirement
Product Specific with Clinical Data	1. Global Publications Lead 2. Functional Head of author 3. GML, PDTL, or GPVP 4. Legal IP 5. TA clinical head or Medic on GPT	
If the publication contains MedImmune author(s), the PSO review must include the corresponding MedImmune reviewers as per Table 1B.		

Payer Evidence and Pricing Group		
Nonscientific	1. Functional Head of author	Nonscientific publications may follow the PSO process, but this is decided by the function. Otherwise, approval of these publications is covered by the AstraZeneca Communications Policy.
Therapy Area Specific	1. Global Publications Lead 2. Functional Head of author* 3. GMLs, GPVP(s), and PDTL(s) of products within TA 4. Legal IP	Legal IP may exempt some publications from the IP review requirement
Product Specific	1. Global Publications Lead 2. Functional Head of author* 3. GML, PTDL, or GP Director/VP 4. Legal IP	Legal IP may exempt some publications from the IP review requirement
Product Specific with Clinical Data	1. Global Publications Lead 2. Functional Head of author* 3. GML, PTDL, or GPVP 4. Legal IP 5. TA clinical head or Medic on GPT	
* If the functional head is an author on the publication and reports into a Commercial role, then an equivalent-level Medical, Clinical or scientific signatory will be identified to perform PSO.		
If the publication contains MedImmune author(s), the PSO review must include the corresponding MedImmune reviewers as per Table 1B.		
Precision Medicine and Other Diagnostics Groups**		
Nonscientific	1. Functional Head of author	Nonscientific publications may follow the PSO process, but this is decided by the function. Otherwise, approval of these publications is covered by the AstraZeneca Communications Policy.
Therapy Area Specific	1. Global Publications Lead 2. Functional Head of author* 3. GMLs, GPVP(s), and PDTL(s) of products within TA 4. Legal IP 5. VP Precision Medicine	Legal IP may exempt some publications from the IP review requirement
Product Specific	1. Global Publications Lead 2. Functional Head of author* 3. GML, PTDL, or GP Director/VP 4. Legal IP 5. VP Precision Medicine	Legal IP may exempt some publications from the IP review requirement

Product Specific with Clinical Data	1. Global Publications Lead 2. Functional Head of author* 3. GML, PDTL, or GPVP 4. Legal IP 5. TA clinical head or Medic on GPT 6. VP Precision Medicine	
* If the functional head is an author on the publication and reports into a Commercial role, then an equivalent-level Medical, Clinical or scientific signatory will be identified to perform PSO. ** As defined in the Global Diagnostics Standard If the publication contains MedImmune author(s), the PSO review must include the corresponding MedImmune reviewers as per Table 1B.		

Table 1E. Pharmaceutical Technology & Development PSO Reviewer Assignment Guide		
Publication Type	Reviewer*	Additional Information
Nonscientific	1. Head of Function 2. Innovation Network member	Nonscientific publications also follow the PSO process in Pharmaceutical Development.
General Scientific/ Non-Product Specific	1. Head of Function/Science Lead 5. Legal IP or Innovation Network member (if approved by Legal IP)	
General Scientific with Compound/ Product Data*	1. Head of Function/Science Lead 2. GML, PDTL, or GPVP of product 5. Legal IP or Innovation Network member (if approved by Legal IP)	PL/GPL copied on review to ensure that publication is in the tactical plan
General Scientific with Compound/ Product Data and Clinical Data**	1. Head of Function/Science Lead 2. GML, PDTL, or GPVP of product 3. Legal IP or Innovation Network member (if approved by Legal IP) 5. Clinical TA VP (if for some reason, Pharm Dev was leading a publication that had clinical data, a clinical VP would need to review)	PL/GPL copied on review to ensure that publication is in the tactical plan
* Where the product is named or its identity could be determined from the included structures, properties, or fingerprint data.		

Table 1F. Marketing Company PSO Reviewer Assignment Guide		
Publication Type	Reviewer	Additional Information
Nonscientific	1. Functional head of author	Nonscientific publications may follow the PSO process, but this is decided by the function. Otherwise, approval of these publications is covered by the AstraZeneca Communications Policy.
Therapy Area Specific	1. Local TA Medical Director or physician 2. Local Functional head 3. Legal IP	For local publications that support the product/brand, the GPL must be notified. Legal IP to confirm locally if they want to exempt some publications from the IP review requirement.
Product Specific (including MedImmune marketed products)	1. Local person managing publication 2. Local Medical Science Director or equivalent physician or Medical Lead 3. Global Publications Lead 4. GML, Global Product Director/VP Development Products 5. Legal IP	For local language publications that are product related or contain data significant to the product, the summary or abstract must be translated into English and sent to the GPL for team review. It is possible that a translation of the full article may also be requested. Legal IP may exempt some publications from the IP review requirement.

1. RESPONSIBILITIES

Not required.

2. GLOSSARY

Terms	Description
ESCR	Externally Sponsored Collaborative Research
ESR	Externally Sponsored Research
GML	Global Medicine Leader
GP	Global Publications
GPL	Global Publications Leader
GPT	Global Product Team
GPVP	Global Product Vice President
IMED	Innovative Medicines and Early Development
IP	Intellectual Property
IISR	Investigator-Initiated Sponsored Research
LT	Leadership Team
PDT	Product Development Team
PDTL	Product Development Team Lead
PL	Publications Lead
PSO	Publications Sign-Off
RIA	Respiratory, Inflammation, and Autoimmunity
SVP	Senior Vice President
TA	Therapy Area
VP	Vice President

3. REFERENCES

AstraZeneca Publications Standard.

4. REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Description of Change
1.0	September 2014	New document
1.1	October 2015	Clarification of sign-off requirements for ESR publications. Delegation of IP review. Changes to PSO reviewer assignment guide based on organisational changes.
1.2	March 2018	Simplification of document. Updates to align with current organizational structure. Recommendation for marketing companies to submit proposals. Identification of Datavision and Clear as the enterprise-wide e-tools for PSO.

5. APPENDICES

Not required.